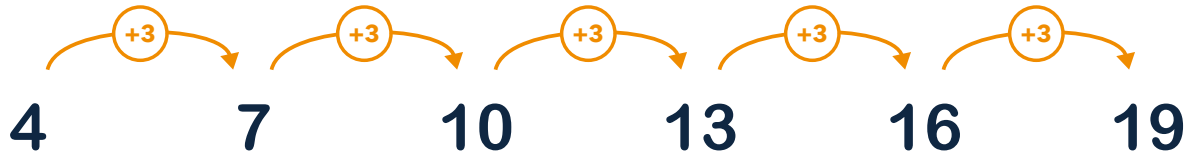
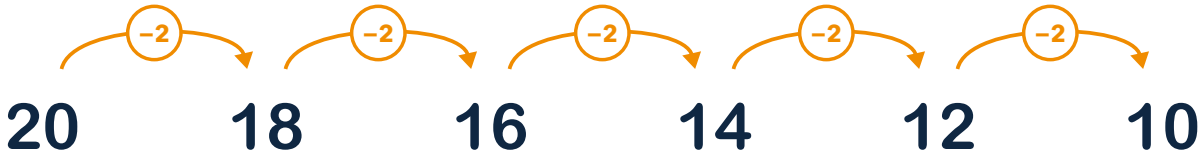
Counting Forward and Backward

Count by any number, from any number, either way.

Count forward by 3s



Count backward by 2s



Count by 25s, like quarters: 25 cents each



Your turn!



For teachers

Goal: count from any number, by any number, forward and backward, in your head. Say it out loud while pointing at each jump. Counting by 3s, 4s and 25s gets kids ready for multiplication and money.

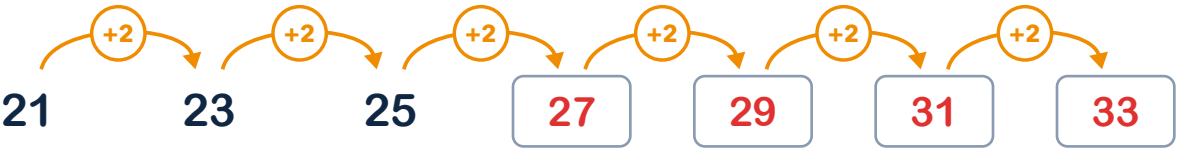
Counting Forward and Backward: Practice

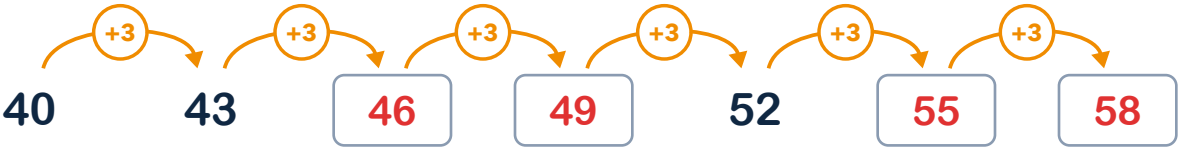
Jump by the same amount each time.

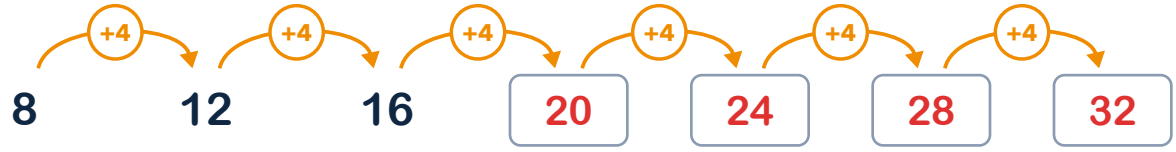
Part 1 Forward by 2s, 3s and 4s Fill in the next numbers.

1) 

2) 

3) 

4) 

5) 

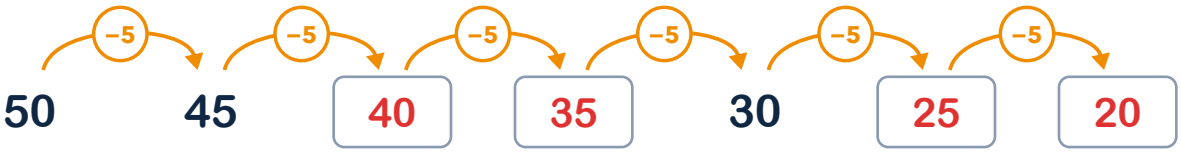
6) 

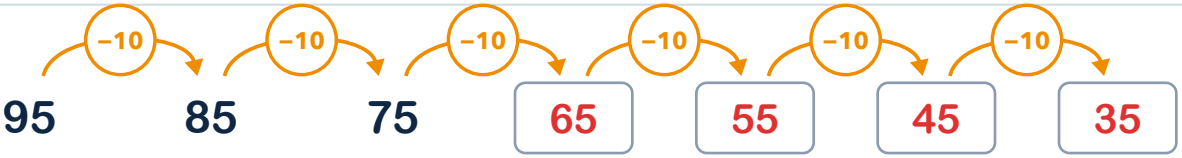
Part 2 Backward Jump back each time. The numbers get smaller.

7) 

Counting Forward and Backward: Practice (continued)

Part 2 Backward (continued)

8) 

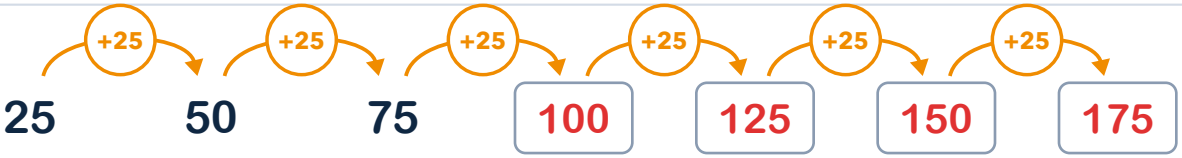
9) 

10) 

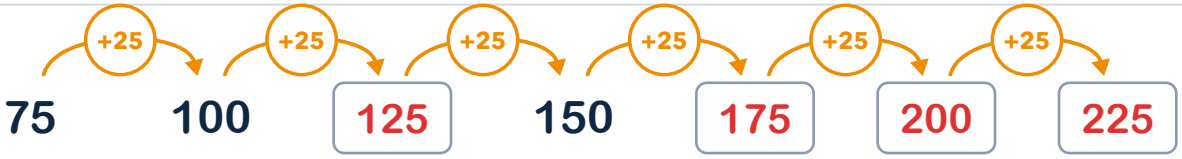
11) 

12) 

Part 3 By 25s 25, 50, 75, 100 … like counting quarters.

13) 

14) 

15) 

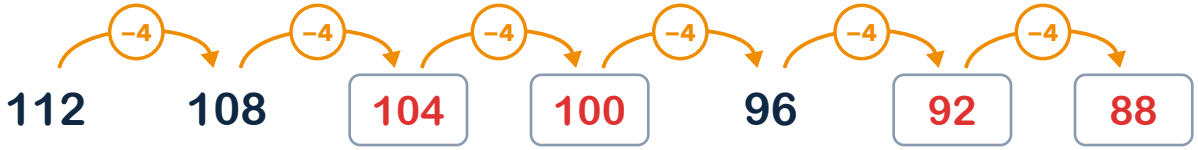
Counting Forward and Backward: Practice (continued)

Part 3 By 25s (continued)

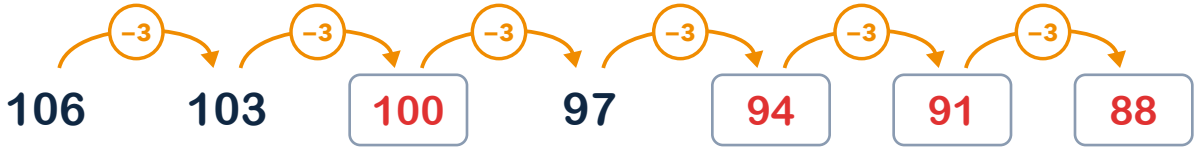
16) 

Part 4 Across a hundred Keep going past 100, or back below it.

17) 

18) 

19) 

20) 

Part 5 Forward or backward? Which way? By how much?

21) 3, 6, 9, 12 — Count **forward** by **3**

22) 40, 36, 32, 28 — Count **back** by **4**

23) 50, 45, 40, 35 — Count **back** by **5**

Counting Forward and Backward: Practice (continued)

Part 5 Forward or backward? (continued)

24) 11, 13, 15, 17 — Count **forward** by **2**

25) 100, 75, 50, 25 — Count **back** by **25**

26) 22, 25, 28, 31 — Count **forward** by **3**

Part 6 Count forward No help this time.

27) 6, 9, **12**, 15, **18**

28) 14, **18**, 22, **26**, 30

29) 35, 40, **45**, **50**, 55

30) 9, 11, 13, **15**, **17**

31) 50, **75**, 100, 125, **150**

32) 17, 20, **23**, 26, **29**

33) 72, **76**, 80, **84**, 88

34) 110, 120, **130**, **140**, 150

Part 7 Count backward No help this time.

35) 20, 18, **16**, 14, **12**

36) 45, **40**, 35, **30**, 25

37) 33, 30, **27**, **24**, 21

38) 28, 24, 20, **16**, **12**

Counting Forward and Backward: Practice (continued)

Part 7 Count backward (continued)

39) 100, 90, 80, 70, 60

40) 150, 125, 100, 75, 50

41) 61, 59, 57, 55, 53

42) 39, 36, 33, 30, 27

Part 8 Jumps in your head No help this time. Count the jumps.

43) 5 + 3 + 3 + 3 = 14

44) 40 − 4 − 4 − 4 = 28

45) 25 + 25 + 25 = 75

46) 9 + 2 + 2 + 2 + 2 = 17

47) 50 − 5 − 5 − 5 = 35

48) 100 − 25 − 25 = 50

49) 12 + 4 + 4 + 4 = 24

50) 30 − 3 − 3 − 3 − 3 = 18

Part 9 Keep counting

51) Count on by 4: 157 161 165 169 173

52) Count back by 2: 153 151 149 147 145

53) Count back by 10: 68 58 48 38 28

Counting Forward and Backward: Practice (continued)

Part 9 Keep counting (continued)

54) Count on by 4: 112 116 120 **124** **128**

55) Count on by 2: 179 181 183 **185** **187**

56) Count back by 3: 113 110 107 **104** **101**

57) Count on by 10: 79 89 99 **109** **119**

58) Count on by 3: 108 111 114 **117** **120**

59) Count back by 3: 115 112 109 **106** **103**

60) Count back by 5: 166 161 156 **151** **146**

61) Count on by 3: 118 121 124 **127** **130**

62) Count on by 4: 80 84 88 **92** **96**

63) Count on by 3: 55 58 61 **64** **67**

64) Count back by 2: 64 62 60 **58** **56**

65) Count back by 3: 105 102 99 **96** **93**

Counting Forward and Backward: Practice (continued)

Part 9 Keep counting (continued)

66) Count back by 3: 175 172 169 166 163

67) Count back by 2: 124 122 120 118 116

68) Count on by 3: 79 82 85 88 91

69) Count on by 4: 144 148 152 156 160

70) Count back by 3: 166 163 160 157 154

71) Count back by 3: 83 80 77 74 71

72) Count back by 2: 75 73 71 69 67

73) Count back by 3: 165 162 159 156 153

74) Count on by 2: 180 182 184 186 188

75) Count on by 3: 92 95 98 101 104

76) Count on by 5: 157 162 167 172 177

77) Count on by 3: 57 60 63 66 69

Counting Forward and Backward: Practice (continued)

Part 9 Keep counting (continued)

78) Count on by 5: 134 139 144 **149** **154**

79) Count back by 3: 174 171 168 **165** **162**

80) Count back by 10: 130 120 110 **100** **90**

Part 10 Word problems Count forward or backward.

81) A frog sits on step 2. It hops up 3 steps at a time. What step is it on after 4 hops?

Number sentence **2, 5, 8, 11, 14**

Answer **14**

Draw or show your work

82) A jar has 40 cookies. Each day 5 cookies are eaten. How many cookies are left after 3 days?

Number sentence **40, 35, 30, 25**

Answer **25** cookies

Draw or show your work

83) You have 3 quarters. A quarter is 25 cents. How many cents do you have?

Number sentence **25, 50, 75**

Answer **75** cents

Draw or show your work

Counting Forward and Backward: Practice (continued)

Part 10 Word problems (continued)

84) Sam has 30 stickers. He gives 4 stickers to each of 3 friends. How many stickers does he have left?

Number sentence 30, 26, 22, 18

Answer 18 stickers

Draw or show your work

85) Challenge: Count back by 3s from 50. What is the first number you say that is less than 40?

Number sentence 50, 47, 44, 41, 38

Answer 38

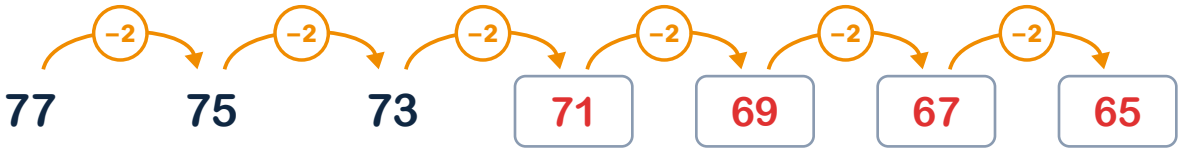
Draw or show your work

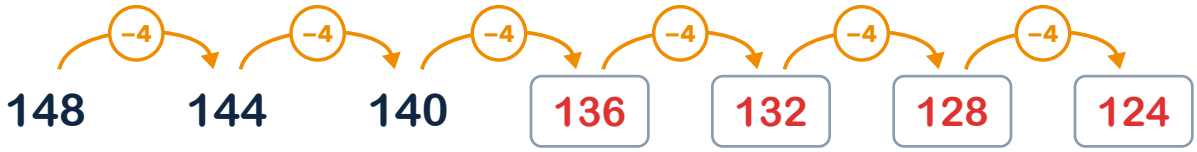
Check-In: Counting Forward and Backward

Show what you know. No help this time.

Mastery: 8 of 10 (80%)

Part 1 Keep counting

1) 

2) 

Part 2 Forward or backward?

3) 58, 83, 108, 133 Count forward by 25

4) 51, 47, 43, 39 Count back by 4

Part 3 Fill in the missing numbers

5) 131, 134, 137, 140, 143

6) 48, 44, 40, 36, 32

7) 35, 30, 25, 20, 15

8) 84, 109, 134, 159, 184

9) 71, 73, 75, 77, 79

10) 136, 140, 144, 148, 152